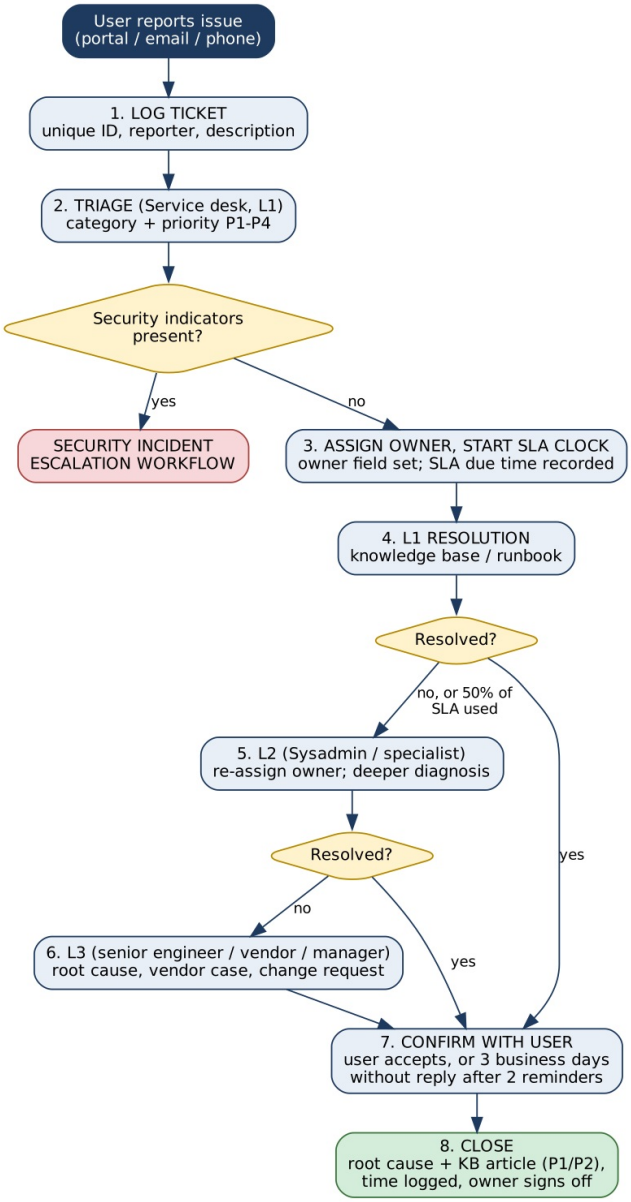
Troubleshooting & Escalation Matrix

Version 1.1 (revised after independent review). Workflow diagrams are in `diagrams/` and embedded below.

1. IT Support Ticket Process Map



Required ticket fields

Field	Purpose
Ticket ID	Unique reference used in every message
Reporter, contact	Who to confirm with
Category	Hardware / Software / Access / Network / Security
Priority (P1-P4)	Set at triage; drives SLA
Owner (assignee)	**Exactly one named person who owns the SLA clock; changes at each escalation level**

SLA due time	Calculated when the owner is assigned (step 3)
Escalation level, history	L1 / L2 / L3 and who handed over to whom
Resolution, root cause	Required at closure (root cause and KB link for P1/P2)

Closure criteria

A ticket is closed only when all of these are true:

1. The reporter confirmed the fix, **or** there was no reply 3 business days after the confirmation request and two reminders (closure note says so).
2. Resolution is described; root cause and a knowledge-base article exist for P1/P2.
3. Time spent is logged and the owner has signed off.
4. Any follow-up work is a separate ticket linked to this one.

Priority & SLA table

Priority	Definition	Example	Response	Resolution target
P1 Critical	Service down or security breach, many users affected	Server outage, ransomware	15 min	4 hours
P2 High	Major function degraded or one VIP/critical user blocked	VPN down for a team	30 min	8 hours
P3 Medium	Single user impacted, workaround exists	Printer, software error	4 hours	3 business days
P4 Low	Request or minor issue	New software request	1 business day	5 business days

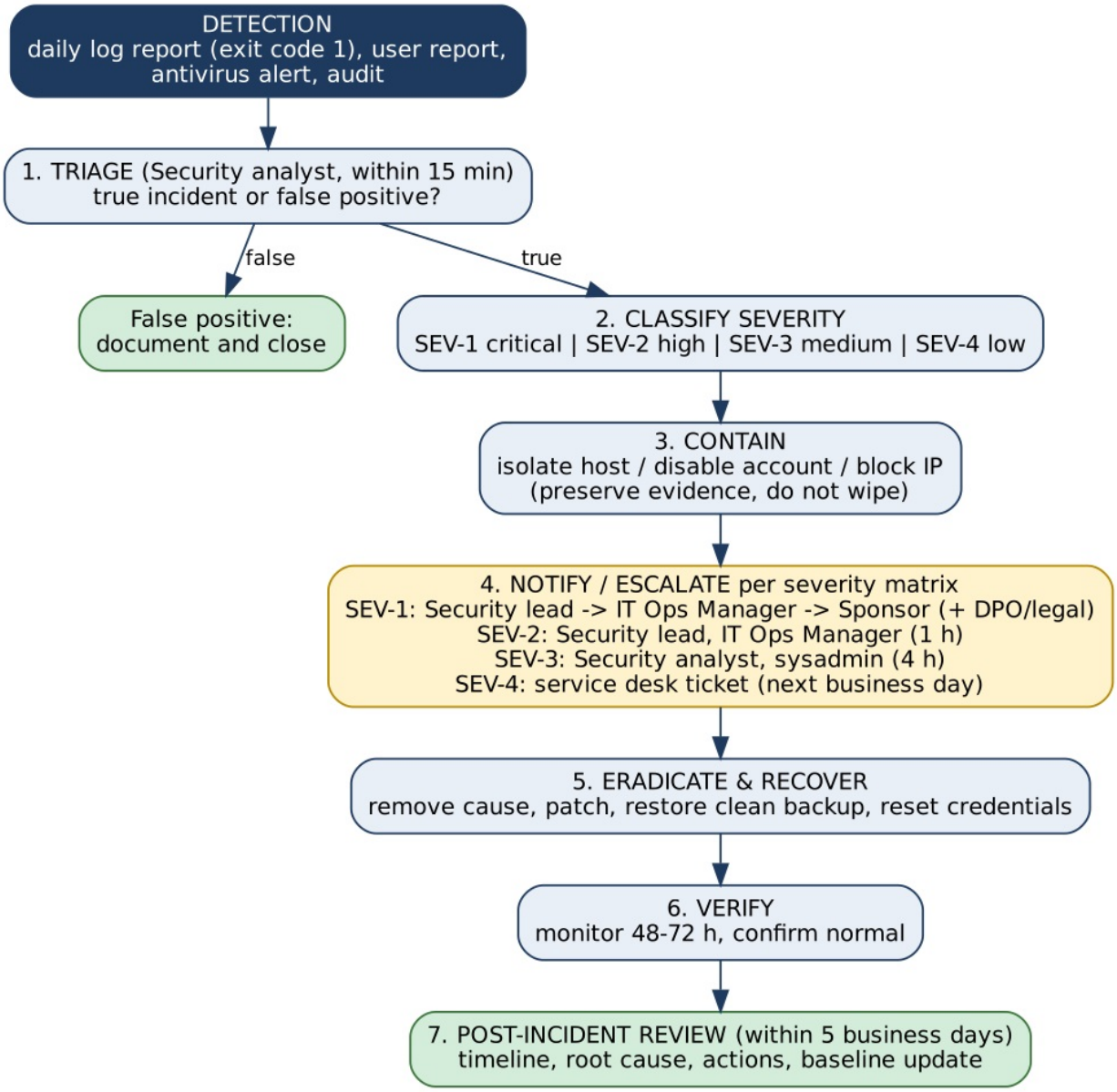
Troubleshooting Quick Matrix

Symptom	First checks (L1)	Escalate to L2 when
Cannot log in	Account locked/expired? Caps Lock, MFA device, password reset	Repeated lockouts, account suspected compromised -> Security
Slow computer	Disk space, running processes (`top` / Task Manager), pending updates, reboot	Persistent after cleanup, signs of malware
No network	Cable/Wi-Fi, IP (`ip a` / `ipconfig`), ping gateway & DNS	Multiple users affected, DHCP/DNS/switch fault
Linux service failing	`systemctl status <svc>`, `journalctl -u <svc> -n 50`, disk/memory	Config or dependency fault, repeated crash
Windows app crash	Event Viewer (Application log), update/reinstall, check disk	Reproducible across users, vendor bug
Disk almost full	`df -h` / `du -sh *`, clear temp/log rotation	Growth unexplained -> possible log flood/incident
Suspicious email	Do not open; report to security	Always forward to Security

2. Escalation Rules

- **Time-based:** escalate to the next level if no progress at 50% of the resolution target; the new owner is recorded in the ticket.
- **Impact-based:** more than 5 users or any critical system affected -> immediate L2 and notify the manager.
- **Risk-based:** any security indicator -> immediate Security escalation regardless of priority.
- **Handover quality:** each escalation includes ticket ID, symptoms, steps already taken, logs/screenshots and business impact.

3. Security Incident Escalation Workflow



Severity & Notification Matrix

Severity	Examples	Escalate to	Time	Actions
SEV-1	Ransomware, confirmed data breach, domain admin compromise	Security lead -> IT Ops Manager -> Sponsor / management (and legal/DPO where personal data is involved)	Immediate (within 15 min)	Isolate, incident bridge call, preserve evidence
SEV-2	Malware on one host, successful brute-force login, privilege escalation, unapproved account with admin rights	Security lead, IT Ops Manager	Within 1 hour	Disable account, isolate host, reset credentials
SEV-3	Brute-force burst: **5 or more failed attempts from one source IP within 10 minutes** (the analyzer's default `--threshold 5 --window`	Security analyst, sysadmin	Within 4 hours	Block IP, user coaching,

	`10`), sudo failures, new account, policy violation, suspicious email clicked			monitor
SEV-4	Fewer than 5 failed attempts in the window, root login attempts, dormant account, minor policy deviation	Service desk ticket	Next business day	Log and trend

The analyzer assigns these same severities; if the thresholds are changed in the script they must be changed here too (change request to the Security lead).

RACI for Incidents

Activity	Service Desk	Sysadmin	Security	IT Manager
Detect & log	R	C	C	I
Triage & classify	C	C	R/A	I
Contain	I	R	A	I
Communicate to management	I	I	R	A
Recover	I	R	A	I
Post-incident review	C	C	R	A

R = Responsible, A = Accountable, C = Consulted, I = Informed.

Data-breach note

If personal data is affected, involve the data-protection officer immediately; under GDPR the supervisory authority must be notified within 72 hours of becoming aware of a breach where required.